Earl Hickson Jr.

HCI Graduate Applicant | UX Engineer

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APPLICANT SUMMARY

UX Engineer and independent HCI practitioner with a background in graphic design, frontend engineering, and full-stack product development. My work explores how interactive systems can strengthen human capability across relationships, learning, privacy, and complex decision-making without unnecessarily replacing human agency.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-computer interaction | Learning technologies | Privacy and consent | Decision support | Information architecture | Accessibility | Human agency and automation

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Graphic Design | Kean University | 2015

IBM Full Stack Software Developer Professional Certificate | IBM / Coursera | December 2025

Verify certificate

SELECTED INDEPENDENT HCI INVESTIGATIONS

WithYou | Independent HCI investigation

How should shared technology support connection without assuming unrestricted access?

Contribution: Solo product design, UX engineering, and full-stack development. Evidence boundary: The legacy sharing path weakens otherwise more granular privacy controls.

ehicksonjr.com/work/withyou

DojoNet | Independent HCI investigation

How can digital systems support progression without reducing learning to completion?

Contribution: Solo product design and frontend product development. Evidence boundary: Instructor workflows require further design and implementation verification.

ehicksonjr.com/work/dojonet

Gundam Forge | Independent HCI investigation

How can interfaces help people navigate complexity without making the decision for them?

Contribution: Solo product design and full-stack product development. Evidence boundary: Official competitive ban/restriction coverage is incomplete.

ehicksonjr.com/work/gundam-forge

TECHNICAL PREPARATION

Interaction & product: User flows, Information architecture, Interaction design, Prototyping, Responsive design, Design systems, Accessibility

Frontend engineering: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, Component architecture, State management

Backend & data: Node.js, Express, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Supabase, Authentication, Real-time systems

Quality & delivery: Behavior testing, Testing Library, Accessibility auditing, Git and GitHub, CI/CD, Vite, Deployment workflows

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Front-End Developer & Digital Integration Specialist | AMA Fight Club

Jan 2025 - 2025 | Fitness / Operations

- Redesigned the responsive website and improved its mobile experience.
- Integrated Zen Planner lead-capture and CRM workflows, recruiting forms, and QR campaigns.
- Evaluated platforms and digital tools supporting operations and marketing.

Front-End Developer | Asembia

Dec 2023 - Oct 2024 | Healthcare / Enterprise

- Developed reusable component and design-system patterns across healthcare platforms.
- Migrated Bootstrap 3 interfaces to Bootstrap 5 and improved prescriber-portal information layouts.
- Integrated REST APIs in a .NET environment and applied accessibility practices to regulated workflows.
- Presented component architecture and product value to executive leadership.

Lead Designer & Front-End Developer | BroadcastMed

Nov 2021 - Mar 2023 | Healthcare / Media

- Designed and developed healthcare microsites and responsive landing experiences.
- Created a standardized HTML email system and used Analytics and Hotjar findings to guide UX work.
- Mentored teammates and strengthened code-review and QA practices.

Freelance Front-End Developer | Merck

2019 | Healthcare / Communications

Frontend development supporting digital marketing and communications initiatives.

Front-End Developer | Verizon Wireless

2015 - 2016 | Telecommunications

Consumer-facing digital interfaces and internal tools.

TEACHING AND LEADERSHIP

Teaching Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu informs Earl's approach to progressive instruction, observation, feedback, adaptation, trust, reflection, and capability development.

No academy title or teaching date range is published until those details are confirmed.

RESEARCH PREPARATION

Methods used: Analytics review | Hotjar-informed evaluation | Accessibility auditing | Interaction prototyping | Design-system evaluation | Implementation analysis | Technical usability review

Methods sought through graduate study: Semi-structured interviews | Usability testing | Diary studies | Contextual inquiry | Observation | Qualitative coding | Experimental design | Mixed methods | Research ethics

SELECTED WRITING

Teaching Jiu-Jitsu Changed the Way I Think About UX | Learning | July 14, 2026

Designing Consent Into Digital Products | Relationships | July 14, 2026

What Trading Card Games Teach Us About Information Architecture | Decision Support | July 14, 2026